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CFO-RC F

2000 - 128

RESULTS: Rec 1/11/01 upl

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM
(PLEASE PRINT OR TYPE. ATTACH PHOTOGRAPHS, DRAWINGS AND ADDITIONAL PAGES AS NECESSARY)

SPECIES: Blackburnian Warbler (Common Name) Dendroica fusca (Scientific Name)

DATE(S) OF OBSERVATION: Sept. 1, 2, 2000

NUMBER OF BIRDS SEEN: 1 SEX: female PLUMAGE: 1st fall

EXACT LOCATION: Belmar Park, Lakewood 800 S. Wadsworth

COUNTY: Jefferson NEAREST TOWN: Lakewood ELEVATION: 5440'

LENGTH OF OBSERVATION: 30 min. TIME(S) OF OBSERVATION: 0840 - 0855 9/1
early a.m. 9/2

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO SAW THE BIRD(S) WITH YOU:

Warren Finch , Tammy Ellsworth, Ira Sanders

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO INDEPENDENTLY SAW THE BIRD(S):

several birders both days

LIGHT CONDITIONS (QUALITY; DIRECTION RELATIVE TO BIRD(S); POSITION):

Sun , full light all sides and some shade

OPTICAL EQUIPMENT USED:

Swarovski 8 x 56 bino

DISTANCE FROM BIRD (ESTIMATED UNLESS OTHERWISE NOTED): 15-25', 4-20' high in trees

WAS BIRD PHOTOGRAPHED? no IF SO, HAVE YOU SUBMITTED PHOTOS?

WHO TOOK THE PHOTOGRAPHS?

DESCRIBE THE GENERAL AND SPECIFIC HABITAT IN WHICH THE BIRD(S) OCCURRED:

Public park. Blue spruce, weeping willows and aspens, shrubs all along banks of large man-made pond and concrete path, lawns. Many passerine species migrating through park this week.

DESCRIBE THE BIRD'S BEHAVIOR (FLYING; FEEDING; HABITS; BEHAVIORS USED IN IDENTIFYING THE SPECIES OR IN SUPPORTING THE IDENTIFICATION):

Warbler gleaning style and mixed species feeding - actively, methodically scouring branches, leaves and needles with Black-capped Chickadee, Wilson's Warbler, Yellow-rumped Warbler. Very bold, often perched in clear view at such close range I was forced to back away for clear focus. Some "fly-catching" and hover-gleaning behavior seen. No evidence of tail bobbing.

DESCRIPTION:

Medium warbler size. Uppers: dusky gray from forehead to rump, shading to darker gray/blackish tail (with white outer rectrices) and wings. Two white wing bars formed by white tips to greater and median secondary coverts. Back showed subdued black stripes that were set off by 2 buffy-yellow stripes, one on either side of the back near at the scapular junction. Long, pale yellow supralores and supercilium extended to the rear of gray auriculars. Same yellow shade formed crescent below dark eye. Dark/olive eyeline bordered upper edge of auriculars, which were sharply angled at rear and bottom. A pale band separated auriculars from scapular/back/shoulder areas. Pale yellow from throat extended into malar region outlining lower border of auriculars, essentially isolating the ear coverts (auriculars). Bill: dusky, slender, pointed.

Unders: Pale yellow from throat through breast to low belly, faint yellow-buff on undertail coverts. Wide dusky streaks showed along sides and flanks; legs black.

BIRD'S CALL: "chip" note, repeated several times.

SIMILAR SPECIES: 1 female Townsend's Warbler lacks black back streaks/stripes and and pale back "braces", generally brighter yellow plumage.

1 female Cerulean - upperparts brighter greenish, lack pale back braces. Auriculars less distinctive in shape and color and not "isolated" to the degree seen on Blackburnian

1 female Blackpoll }
1 female Bay-breasted } supercilium more subdued, lack gray auriculars and pale back braces. Often bob tails, not observed in this sighting.

Dunn: "Pale braces on back are diagnostic for this species among Dendroica warblers", those most similar to Blackburnian. The very pale yellow underparts led me to determining this bird was a female.

PRIOR EXPERIENCE: This is the first 1st fall Blackburnian I have had a chance to study at close range for such an extended period of time. Have seen only 1 female Cerulean Warbler and Bay-breasted, few female Blackpolls. Saw several 1st fall female Townsend's at the same park.

BOOKS: National Geo. with me, used as basis for group discussion of species i.d. while watching warbler. Dunn's Warblers used later to determine age and sex and specific text discussion on similar species of warblers.

This report: made from field notes written during observation.

DATE REPORT WRITTEN: Sept. 5, 2000

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